

Fern's Voice Training!

Warm-up

Belly Breathing

- Place one hand on your chest and one hand on your belly.
- **Inhale:** Breathe in through your nose. Think about breathing low to fill up the bottom of your lungs. As you breathe in you should feel your belly press out and/or your ribs expand to the sides. The hand on your chest should stay relatively still.
- **Exhale:** Breathe out with pursed lips. As you breathe out gently contract your abdominals. Think about pressing the air up from below as you exhale.
- Use this breathing throughout all voice exercises.

Cup Bubbles

- Take a relaxed breath in, then blow slowly into a straw to make bubbles in a cup of water.
- Hum while exhaling and try to move the hum to the front of the mouth.
- Slide the pitch of the hum sound up and down with steady control.
- Try to exhale for 5 to 10 seconds.

MMM Sounds

- Hold a hum sound for 5 to 8 seconds.
- Try to notice the forward vibration on your lips.

MMM Syllables

Using the **MMM Sounds** technique, say the following syllables.

- Me Me
- May May
- My My
- Moe Moe
- Moo Moo

Sustained "AH"

Take a deep breath and hold a strong, clear "AH" for at least 10 seconds.

Glides with "AH"

Take a deep breath and glide up in pitch with a strong, clear "AH".

Phonation

Easy Onset Practice

Say the following word pairs. At the second word, try to mimic the feeling of using air to begin the sound instead of a hard start.

hail • ale	harm • arm	heel • eel	his • is
hair • air	has • as	high • I	hit • it
hall • all	hear • ear	hike • Ike	hive • I've
ham • am	heat • eat	hill • ill	how • ow

Vocal Onset Sentences

Using the **Easy Onset** technique, say the following sentences with relaxed voicing.

- Our Uncle Alan is always angry.
- It is impossible to understand arithmetic.
- Eric's umbrella is under the overhang.
- Astronauts are unbelievably ambitious.
- Everyone asks if Amy is my aunt.
- I'll have already eaten enough oatmeal.
- Emma is an unusually artistic adolescent.
- If you enter early, attendants are available in the aisles.
- Actors arrive at the awards in expensive attire.
- Accountants are always extremely accurate.
- Ethan and Ivana are always at the opera.
- Olivia was embarrassed by all of Arthur's attention.
- It was an eye-opening experience for Allison.
- It is an effort to understand Uncle Edward's accent.
- Otto's used automobiles are usually under eight thousand dollars.

Resonance

M — One-syllable Words

Start all of the following words on a hum sound and carry it through without dropping your voice into your throat.

- | | | | |
|---------|---------|---------|---------|
| • mad | • may | • mink | • mop |
| • made | • meal | • mint | • more |
| • mail | • mean | • mist | • moss |
| • main | • meet | • mix | • most |
| • make | • meek | • mob | • moth |
| • mall | • melt | • mode | • mound |
| • malt | • merge | • mold | • mourn |
| • man | • mess | • mole | • mouse |
| • map | • met | • mom | • mouth |
| • mare | • mild | • monk | • move |
| • mark | • mile | • month | • munch |
| • mash | • milk | • mood | • must |
| • mask | • mind | • moon | • my |
| • match | • mine | • moose | |

M — Two-syllable Words

As before, start all of the following words on a hum sound and carry it through without dropping your voice into your throat.

- | | | | |
|------------|------------|------------|--------------|
| • machine | • measure | • million | • monkey |
| • magic | • meatloaf | • mindless | • monster |
| • maiden | • melon | • minute | • moody |
| • mailbag | • melted | • misread | • moonbeam |
| • major | • member | • mitten | • morning |
| • mango | • memo | • mixer | • mouthpiece |
| • manmade | • menace | • mobile | • movie |
| • maple | • merger | • model | • mower |
| • market | • merit | • mohawk | • muscle |
| • marshall | • messy | • moldy | • music |
| • mascot | • metric | • molten | • musty |
| • master | • middle | • monarch | • myself |
| • matchbox | • mighty | • money | |

M — Sentences

Using the resonant voice developed by the **M Words**, say each of the following sentences.

- Meet my mom.
- Mix mint milk.
- Merge more movies.
- Moths make a mess.
- March for a mile.
- Mark my mailbag.
- Make maple malt.
- Mean marketers mumble.
- Munch on mushy melons.
- March on Main Street.
- Meet the man at the metal mine.
- Measure a million miles.
- Muddy mowers make a mess.
- Master movers never mess up.
- Metric machines mean more money.
- Mark the message before I move.
- Mom melted my magic mascot.
- Middle school menaces are mean.
- Musicians' mouthpieces make music.
- Monsters move in the moonbeams.
- My mouse and monkey wear mini mittens.
- Members made mobiles with modern matchboxes.
- Monarchs love misty mangos in the morning.
- Mountain climbers are mystified by monumental peaks.
- Mounds of mud messed up the merging motorists.
- Moss and mold are not manmade materials.
- Markets in Montana collect money from mountaineers.
- Mysterious marble is magnified with a microscope.
- Marathon runners move quickly on the last mile.
- Miniature mice made a home in my mousetrap.

Intonation

Sentences

Say each sentence twice, once as a statement and once as a question. Use falling and rising intonation to differentiate the two respectively.

1. • You want to go to the park.
 • You want to go to the park?
2. • I have to pay my bills on Wednesday.
 • I have to pay my bills on Wednesday?
3. • His mother's name is Susan.
 • His mother's name is Susan?
4. • The visiting team won the game.
 • The visiting team won the game?
5. • Tomorrow we will have the party.
 • Tomorrow we will have the party?
6. • There is no more room in this cabinet.
 • There is no more room in this cabinet?
7. • It has been six months since we last spoke.
 • It has been six months since we last spoke?
8. • Someone is knocking at the door.
 • Someone is knocking at the door?
9. • Your prom dress is lavender.
 • Your prom dress is lavender?
10. • It is too late to call her at home.
 • It is too late to call her at home?
11. • Kimberly's cat has had kittens.
 • Kimberly's cat has had kittens?

Words

Say the following sentence sets using pitch inflection to stress the **bolded** word, not volume.

1. My kitten's name is Casey.
 - **My** kitten's name is Casey.
 - My **kitten's** name is Casey.
 - My kitten's name is **Casey**.
2. Jack goes to college in Pittsburgh.
 - **Jack** goes to college in Pittsburgh.
 - Jack goes to **college** in Pittsburgh.
3. I have to work at 8 a.m. on Thursday.
 - **I** have to work at 8 a.m. on Thursday.
 - I have to **work** at 8 a.m. on Thursday.
 - I have to work at **8 a.m.** on Thursday.
 - I have to work at 8 a.m. on **Thursday**.
4. Phillip's hobby is antique car repair.
 - **Phillip's** hobby is antique car repair.
 - Phillip's **hobby** is antique car repair.
 - Phillip's hobby is antique **car** repair.
 - Phillip's hobby is antique car **repair**.
5. I would like a silver bracelet for graduation.
 - I would like a **silver** bracelet for graduation.
 - I would like a silver **bracelet** for graduation.
 - I would like a silver bracelet for **graduation**.
6. Eric painted his bedroom blue.
 - **Eric** painted his bedroom blue.
 - Eric **painted** his bedroom blue.
 - Eric painted **his** bedroom blue.
 - Eric painted his **bedroom** blue.
 - Eric painted his bedroom **blue**.